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Authority ECI Review May 3, 1979

By Yurk WARS, Date May 4, 1979

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

BY SPECIAL MESSENGER

Date: March 14, 1950

To: Atomic Energy Commission
Building T-3
16th and Constitution Avenue, N. W.
Washington, D. C.
Attention: Mr. Francis R. Hammon
Acting Director
Division of Security

From: John Edgar Hoover, Director - Federal Bureau of Investigation

Subject: UNKNOWN OBJECT OVER OAK RIDGE, TENNESSEE, MARCH 1, 1950
INFORMANT.
VITAL FACILITIES
INTERNAL SECURITY

operator of Radio Station WROL, Knoxville, is reported to have detected on his radar equipment an object directly over Oak Ridge, Tennessee, at an altitude of 40,000 feet at 11:15 p. m., March 1, 1950. On March 2, 1950, he advised that his radar equipment recorded an object about 100,000 feet high and approximately 18 miles from his home in Knoxville at 11:15 a. m. on that date. It was reported that Naval Reserve radar equipment at Knoxville, Tennessee, did not detect an object on any occasion but stated that the equipment was not considered efficient for aircraft at extreme altitudes. It was further reported that qualified persons at Oak Ridge, questioned [redacted] and examined his radar equipment. They reportedly found his equipment not too reliable and felt that [redacted] was technically wrong on some of his radar theory. The reliability of [redacted] was also questioned due to some degree of inebriation.

The above confirms information telephonically furnished to Mr. [redacted] of your office. No investigation is being conducted by this Bureau but in the event additional information comes to our attention you will be promptly advised.

cc - Director of Special Investigations
The Inspector General
Department of the Air Force
The Pentagon
Washington, D. C.

123 10 1-55-50 1230

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~ - REGISTERED MAIL

cc - Director of Intelligence
General Staff
Department of the Army
The Pentagon
Washington 25, D. C. Attention: Chief, Security and Training Group
~~CONFIDENTIAL~~ REGISTERED MAIL

RECORD COPY

(93) 68610 4521

14-Mar-50

(25 Mar 48)

Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

TO : DIRECTOR, FBI

DATE: 3/22/50

FROM : SAC, KNOXVILLE

SUBJECT: VITAL FACILITIES

NATIONAL MILITARY ESTABLISHMENT

(Unknown Object Over Oak Ridge, Tennessee,
3/1/50; STUART ADCOCK - COMPLAINANT).

Re Knoxville teletype to Bureau, Attention Mr. A. H. BELMONT, dated March 6, 1950, entitled "Unknown Object Over Oak Ridge, 3/1/50; STUART ADCOCK - COMPLAINANT".

Referenced teletype advised that the reliability of STUART ADCOCK, complainant in this matter, had been questioned and the efficiency of his radar equipment placed in some doubt. It is felt advisable, however, to apprise the Bureau of all matters in connection with this incident.

At 11:15 P. M. on March 1, 1950, Mr. STUART E. ADCOCK, owner and operator of Radio Station WROL, Hamilton National Bank Building, Knoxville, Tennessee, telephonically communicated with this office advising that he had detected on his privately owned radar equipment an indication of what he believed to be an object circling at an altitude of 40,000 feet over Oak Ridge, Tennessee. At approximately 11:25 P. M. on this date, this information was made available by me to Mr. HOWARD WOODSIDE, Security Division, Atomic Energy Commission, Oak Ridge, for his information. Inasmuch as the matter was not one wherein the Bureau had jurisdiction, no further action was taken.

On the morning of March 2, 1950, Mr. WOODSIDE communicated with Third Army authorities at Ft. McPherson, Georgia and the 14th U. S. Air Force at Greenville, South Carolina, at which time they were advised of the information furnished by ADCOCK.

At approximately 5:30 P. M. on March 2, 1950, a telephone call was received by me from Mr. ADCOCK advising he had been talking with Captain ANDERSON, an assistant to Chief JOHN S. DAVIS of the AEC Security Patrol concerning the reported object over Oak Ridge, Tennessee. ADCOCK further advised that his equipment was surplus Army radar equipment bearing the designation APN-7 which he himself had converted for acceptable use with his radio equipment. He continued that he used this radar equipment to track airliners in and out and with this equipment he could distinguish between a DC-3 and a DC-4. He stated he had again spotted the object at approximately 11:05 A. M. on March 2, 1950 and he estimated it to be approximately twenty miles away at an altitude of 100,000 feet and circling over Oak Ridge.

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100-2415

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ALL INFORMATION CONTAINED
HEREIN IS UNCLASSIFIED
DATE 2/8/83 BY SP-1GSK/PSK
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A short time after receiving the above information, Special Agent E. L. SEAGRAVES, CIC, 3rd Army, stationed at Knoxville, telephonically communicated with this office to determine if any further information had been received regarding the matter reported by ADCOCK. Mr. SEAGRAVES was, at that time, given all of the information which had been received by this office. SEAGRAVES advised that he had been called by his headquarters, CIC, 3rd Army, Atlanta, Georgia, and had been told to look into the matter to determine if it had any basis in fact. Mr. SEAGRAVES continued that he had made arrangements with Mr. STUART ADCOCK to have him and Special Agent W. M. PRICE, OSI, U. S. Air Forces, to visit ADCOCK's home during the evening of March 2, 1950 and observe the radar indications with him. SEAGRAVES advised that neither he nor Mr. PRICE had any radar experience and were in no sense technicians or radar operators, but would make their observations merely to determine if a real reading was being made by ADCOCK.

On the morning of March 3, 1950, SEAGRAVES again telephonically communicated with this office and advised the Liaison Agent, Special Agent CHARLTON C. McSWAIN, that he and PRICE had been with ADCOCK during the previous evening and that they had observed on his radar screen some "pips" which, according to ADCOCK, indicated an object with the same general elevation and azimuth as previously reported by him. SEAGRAVES said they were unable to make any authoritative statement concerning the matter of the object or the reliability of the radar equipment, but they had seen sufficient to give them reason to believe it warranted investigation.

General inquiry at this time at Radio Station WROL and other readily available sources of information divulged the fact that STUART ADCOCK is generally recognized in this vicinity as a reputable and substantial citizen in Knoxville and, in addition thereto, is recognized as somewhat of a radio authority. It was found that he is credited with being a skilled radio technician and has done considerable development and research work in the field of radio.

Due to the interest which was being portrayed by all agencies concerned with this matter, the Bureau at this time was apprised by telephone conversation with A. H. BELMONT at the Bureau concerning the facts known. As a result of this conversation, SA McSWAIN was instructed to follow the matter in the capacity of an observer and to advise the Bureau of any important developments.

Arrangements were made through Lieutenant Commander G. R. SHACKLETT, Commanding Officer, U. S. Naval Reserve Training Center, Alcoa Highway, Knoxville, for the Research Training Center to put into operation radar equipment which they have. At approximately 10:30 A. M. on the same day, this radar

equipment was in operation and continuous search being made. Special Agent McSWAIN, together with Special Agent SEAGRAVES, CIC, and Special Agent PRICE, OSI, observed this Navy equipment for some time but no object whatsoever could be detected. A telephone call was placed by SEAGRAVES to Mr. ADCOCK at approximately 11:00 A. M. and ADCOCK advised he had been picking up some indication of the object again. He indicated its elevation and direction as well as distance to be the same as previously reported. At the time of his conversation, the Navy equipment detected two aircraft at an elevation of approximately 2,000 feet and a general azimuth of approximately 300 degrees true and seemingly headed in the general direction of the Knoxville Municipal Airport. By way of a check, ADCOCK was asked if he detected on his equipment any objects other than those reported by him. ADCOCK stated that he had noticed two small aircraft headed in the general direction of the Knoxville Airport at a relatively low altitude but he had not paid much attention to them. ADCOCK then requested that he be allowed to view the radar equipment at the Naval Reserve Armory in order that he might coordinate his equipment with that equipment and thus obtain a better fix on the object should it again be located. The radar watch was continued and at about 11:30 A. M. ADCOCK called the armory and advised that the object being observed by him over Oak Ridge had started moving in an easterly direction and had, in a period of about twenty minutes, faded from the screen.

On the afternoon of March 3, 1950 at about 1:30 P. M., STUART ADCOCK, together with CIC, OSI and FBI agents, went to the Naval Armory where ADCOCK was allowed to look at the radar equipment of the Navy. It had been previously determined from Lieutenant Commander SHACKLETT that this equipment did not comprise any classified information. At this time, ADCOCK claimed familiarity with the equipment being used by the Navy and spoke of having assisted in its development at Harvard University during the early stages of the war. ADCOCK also made statements to the effect that he had traveled extensively for the Army during the war in adapting radar for specialized services. At this time, the presence of some alcohol was noted on the breath of ADCOCK, but he was not in an inebriated condition. After examining the equipment, ADCOCK stated he did not feel that this low frequency type of radar would be of much assistance in detecting the object reported by him for several reasons, such as the elevation of the antenna, the minimum fade area, etc. These statements seemed to be in accord with the radar operator's opinion.

At 3:30 P. M. on the afternoon of March 3, 1950, a conference was had with Colonel C. D. GASSER, Engineering Officer, U. S. Air Force Material Command, NEPA Site, Oak Ridge, Tennessee. Those present at the conference were Special Agent SEAGRAVES, CIC; Special Agent PRICE, OSI; Mr. GENE GOEDJEN, U. S. Air Forces Security Officer; Captain ROBERT CROSS, USAF, and Special Agent CHARLTON C. McSWAIN of this office. At this conference, Colonel GASSER

stated that while it was highly improbable that aircraft could sustain flight at an altitude of 100,000 feet, it was absolutely possible from a scientific and engineering standpoint. Therefore, it was his opinion that the matter should be followed closely. He arranged for Captain CROSS, whom he termed a radar expert, to observe with ADCOCK during the evening of March 3, 1950 the radar equipment on which ADCOCK had detected the object.

Immediately following this conference, Special Agent McSWAIN contacted Mr. CHARLES WHITE, Physical Security and Plant Protection Branch, U. S. AEC, and Mr. FRANK CALLAGHAN, Assistant Chief, Security Division, U. S. AEC, to advise them of the findings and to determine what action was being taken by AEC. Both WHITE and CALLAGHAN advised that the matter had been referred to 3rd Army authorities and that beyond this, no steps had been taken. It was their belief, however, that a radar technician was being sent down, probably from Washington, to inspect the equipment owned by ADCOCK. It was erroneously reported that a CIA technician would come to Oak Ridge.

Also, immediately following this conference above stated, Special Agent PRICE, OSI, called his headquarters at Maxwell Field, Alabama to determine if any action were being taken with regard to having radar equipment flown to this area to verify or disprove the findings of ADCOCK. PRICE was advised that he should act only in the capacity of an observer in the matter but that such radar equipment would be flown up, if requested by the AEC.

Special Agent SEAGRAVES, CIC, stated he had also been advised by his headquarters at Atlanta to act in the capacity of an observer and that, accordingly, he had not as yet been advised whether or not the 3rd Army intended to send mobile radar equipment to the area to verify or disprove the findings of ADCOCK. Inquiry was made by Special Agent PRICE, OSI, of AEC as to whether or not they would request having radar equipment flown in by OSI authorities, and he was told by AEC that while the AEC was, of course, vitally interested in anything which directly affected the safety of the area, they nevertheless did not feel that they had the authority to make a specific request for such action inasmuch as the protection of the area from assault was the responsibility of the 3rd Army. Accordingly, they could not make any direct request for such equipment.

During the evening of March 3, 1950, Special Agent CHARLTON C. McSWAIN and myself, together with SA PRICE (OSI), remained at the Naval Reserve Armory, Alcoa Highway, during which time search was being conducted by the radar equipment at this installation. Captain ROBERT CROSS, NEPA, and Special Agent SEAGRAVES, CIC,

were at the home of STUART ADCOCK observing his radar equipment during this search. No object was reported by ADCOCK during this evening and therefore Captain CROSS had no opportunity to observe his equipment in action, particularly in reference to the reported object at such phenomenal altitudes. No unusual objects were detected by the radar equipment of the U. S. Naval Reserve Armory during the entire evening.

Upon abandoning the watch on this evening, a meeting was held with Captain CROSS after leaving ADCOCK's residence in order to ascertain CROSS' opinion. CROSS stated he had found ADCOCK to be technically incorrect in several matters relating to radar theory and practice and, in addition thereto, had very grave doubts as to the capabilities of the surplus APN-7 radar set which had been adapted by ADCOCK. He stated, however, that he had insufficient opportunity to observe the set in practice or to examine the radio equipment connected with the set to make any definite statements as to whether or not the detection of the unknown object would be possible with said equipment. He said, however, he did feel that ADCOCK was a capable person with pure radio techniques.

On the morning of March 4, 1950 at 10:30 A. M. ADCOCK again contacted Special Agent McSWAIN of this office and Special Agent SEAGRAVES, CIC, to advise that he had again received indications of the object at approximately 100,000 feet directly over Oak Ridge and that the intensity of the radar "pip" was stronger than noted at any time previous. At about 11:40 A. M. ADCOCK again called and advised he had watched the object until approximately 11:10 A. M., at which time he had noted it stopped circling and headed off in an easterly direction at approximately 200 miles per hour, at which time it had faded from the screen in slightly less than 20 minutes.

On the afternoon of March 4, 1950, Colonel C. D. GASSER and Captain ROBERT CROSS, both NEPA, visited the home of ADCOCK and carefully examined his radio and radar equipment, including the antenna and related mechanisms. After such examination and after talking at some length with ADCOCK, these two gentlemen met with Special Agent SEAGRAVES (CIC), PRICE (OSI) and McSWAIN (FBI), to give their opinions. Colonel GASSER advised they had found ADCOCK in a much inebriated condition and that they had had difficulty in making any determination as to his abilities in the field of radar. It was their belief that his equipment was haphazard at best and that no great degree of reliability could be placed therein. They did state, however, they intended to return during the morning of March 5, 1950, which was the usual time for the object to be detected.

On the morning of March 5, 1950, Colonel GASSER and Captain CROSS went to the home of Mr. ADCOCK and were unable to gain entry or to find anyone at the residence. After this experience, it was the belief of these two gentlemen

that the reliability of ADCOCK was extremely dubious and they felt that the matter was worthy of little consideration.

On the morning of March 6, 1950, ADCOCK again contacted Special Agent SEAGRAVES, CIC, and advised he had again observed the object at about the same altitude over the Oak Ridge area and he estimated the object to be of approximately the same density as would be caused by a DC-4 at that altitude. Again, Colonel GASSER was contacted by Special Agent PRICE of OSI and Colonel GASSER said that he intended to take some electronic equipment to the home of ADCOCK with which they could actually check the electrical circuits of his radar equipment to determine whether or not it was accurate, particularly in view of the fact they had checked some of the findings of ADCOCK with regard to known aircraft detected during previous visits and found him to be off to a considerable extent regarding speed, elevation and azimuth. During the afternoon of March 6, 1950, all day of March 7, and the morning of March 8, 1950, attempts were made by Special Agent PRICE, OSI, to get in touch with ADCOCK to make an appointment with Colonel GASSER and Captain CROSS, and ADCOCK could not be located. According to his office at Station WROL, he had left town and it was not known when he would return.

In summary, therefore, it seems to be the general opinion that the actual existence of an object at such an exceptional altitude is quite improbable and no explanation is yet known as to just what was detected by ADCOCK on his screen or, in fact, whether anything was detected. On the afternoon of March 8, 1950, Special Agent SEAGRAVES telephoned Special Agent [REDACTED] of this office and advised that two representatives of the 14th Air Forces with headquarters at Greenville, South Carolina, had arrived in Knoxville and contacted him with regard to making an appointment with ADCOCK to inspect his equipment. These representatives advised they did not feel it sufficiently important for them to remain or to make a return trip inasmuch as ADCOCK was unavailable.

This information is being furnished to the Bureau in detail inasmuch as it is the understanding of this office that Colonel C. D. GASSER was much perturbed in the manner in which this matter was handled and has written letters to his Commanding Officer, U. S. Air Forces Material Command, Wright Field, concerning it. These letters by Colonel GASSER apparently were prompted from the fact that the 3rd Army Intelligence representative and the Air Force Intelligence representative have both been instructed to act as observers only, with no authority to act in the situation. In addition thereto, AEC felt that their responsibility had been discharged upon notifying the 3rd Army. The Bureau was obviously interested only from an observer's viewpoint and no question of jurisdiction in this regard was raised.

On the morning of March 7, 1950, Special Agent McSWAIN of this office was advised by Mr. HOWARD WOODSIDE, U. S. AEC Security Division, of steps taken by AEC in this regard. Mr. WOODSIDE stated that immediately upon receiving the report from me, he had made the matter known to the proper authorities at AEC and early the following morning he had conversed with Colonel JOHN MEADE, 3rd Army Headquarters, Atlanta, Georgia, and apprised him of the matter. Mr. WOODSIDE stated he also conversed with 14th Air Force Headquarters at Greenville, South Carolina and advised them of the matter. He stated that this was strictly in accordance with the plans drawn up between AEC and the armed forces for protection against air or land assault. He continued that the AEC has neither the facilities nor the equipment with which to defend itself in such emergencies and that such responsibility had been assumed by these agencies of the military forces.

It would appear from the manner in which this incident was handled that despite the fact that all agencies seemed to be operating in the manner prescribed by agreement, and although each was apprised of the action being taken by the other and cooperating in every respect, there nevertheless seemed to be an impressive lack of any agency actually taking the responsibility for the situation and taking any action to verify or disprove the threat. Had a similar incident occurred wherein an actual threat against the physical security of the AEC Installation had been experienced, it is not implausible to believe that a similar confused fixing of final authority would have been found. It should be noted that many hours elapsed from the receiving of the first report until such time as any reasonable conclusion could be reached concerning the matter and nothing of a positive nature with regard to any action being taken had been had during all that time. While it is now felt that this entire matter was in a manner of speaking "dry run", it nevertheless warrants some consideration from a procedural standpoint and might be worthy of discussion at some liaison meeting in the future.

The Bureau will be immediately advised if there are any further developments in this matter.

~~SECRET~~

HEADQUARTERS THIRD ARMY
FORT MCPHERSON, GEORGIA

AJACI-4 333.5

27 October 1950

SUBJECT: Investigation of unidentified objects over the AEC
Installation

TO: AC of S, G-2, Intelligence
GSUSA
Washington 25, D. C.

DECLASSIFIED

S-79-10-
By 7 NARS, Date 4/14/79

1. Transmitted herewith for information, comment, and/or coordination with other agencies, is a file on investigation of reports from Oak Ridge regarding objects over the AEC Installation for period of 13 October through 25 October 1950.

2. The identifying markings of this file are as follows:

a. Tab "A" - Summary of Information, FAO #8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tenn. 13 Oct 50 (Secret).

b. Tab "B" - Summary of Information, FAO #8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tenn. 17 Oct 50 (Secret).

c. Tab "C" - Summary of Information, FAO #8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tenn. 21 Oct 50, with 13 inclosures (Secret).

d. Tab "D" - Summary of Information, FAO #8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tenn. 25 Oct 50 (Secret).

e. Tab "E" - Disposition Form and Office Memorandum- Report of Investigation, Hq Third Army, G-2 Section, 24-25 Oct 50 (Secret).

5 Incls:

1. Tab "A"
2. Tab "B"
3. Tab "C"
4. Tab "D"
5. Tab "E"

JOHN MEADE
Colonel, GSC
AC of S, G-2

PERMANENT RECORDS COPY.

I PIC (Encls A thru tab "E")

(93) 8.2 452.1

27 Oct 50

(25 Mar 48)

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SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

DATE 13 October 1950

PREPARING OFFICE

111th CIC Detachment, FAO # 8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tennessee

SUBJECT

OBJECTS SIGHTED OVER OAK RIDGE, TENN.

CODE FOR USE IN INDIVIDUAL PARAGRAPH EVALUATION

OF SOURCE:

COMPLETELY RELIABLE A
 USUALLY RELIABLE B
 FAIRLY RELIABLE C
 NOT USUALLY RELIABLE D
 UNRELIABLE E
 RELIABILITY UNKNOWN F

OF INFORMATION:

CONFIRMED BY OTHER SOURCES . . . 1
 PROBABLY TRUE 2
 POSSIBLY TRUE 3
 DOUBTFULLY TRUE 4
 IMPROBABLE 5
 TRUTH CANNOT BE JUDGED 6

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

The night of 12 and 13 October 1950, after 2325 hours on 12 October 1950, objects were sighted in the radar scope of the Knoxville, McGee-Tyson, Airport, radar scopes. The first objects were sighted at 2325 hours E.S.T., traveling at approximately 190 degrees, 1500 - 3000 feet altitude, at 100 to 125 miles per hour. The radar station immediately called Atomic Energy Commission to inform them that there was no report of any aircraft flying in the vicinity. At 2330 hours a fighter of the 5th All Weather Fighter Sqd., 52nd. All Weather Fighter Wing, stationed at McGee-Tyson Airport, Knoxville, Tennessee, "scrambled" to intercept these unidentified objects. At the same time Knoxville Civil Aeronautical authorities were contacted and they advised that no aircraft were known to be flying in the vicinity. The "scrambled" fighter was airborne at 2339 and shortly thereafter, according to the radar scope, was seen to intercept the hostile objects. The fighter pilot advised that no object was visible so the control vectored him so as to intercept this object two more times. On all three occasions neither the pilot nor the observer saw any object visually and no object was sighted in the fighter aircraft's radar scope. At 0014 hours on 13 October 1950 the fighter made a "complete sweep of the control area" in an attempt to locate any of the targets (approximately 5) shown on the control radar screen.

Capt. W. Akin, Control Officer at the Knoxville Radar Station, stated that the radar targets were approximately the size of a small aircraft and that the "pips" would increase and fade in intensity making the target resemble, alternately, a I-5 and a C-47. Capt. Akin ordered the fighter to land and did not recall the fighter at a later hour, 0100 - 13 October 1950, when more targets of the same intensity, at approximately the same altitude, and flying in the similar magnitude were sighted, however, Capt. Summers of the Air Defense Command, Control Center, Sulfridge Field, Detroit, Michigan, was notified. Capt. Summers advised that there were no practice missions scheduled in that area. At 0210 hours, the Eastern Air Defense Command Headquarters, Stewart Air Force Base, Newburgh, N. Y. were advised of the existing conditions and they stated that investigators would be sent that day.

At approximately 1400 hours, 13 October 1950, investigators from the Eastern Air Defense Command; Office of Special Investigations; Security Division, Atomic Energy Commission, Oak Ridge, Tennessee; and Agents of this headquarters, met at the radar site in Knoxville to discuss these radar sightings. Several theories were advanced, some of which were technical in nature, and others which were rejected due to improbability.

It was not believed that unidentified aircraft were responsible for these radar sightings because before the second group appeared on the screen the Security Patrol of the Atomic Energy Commission, Oak Ridge, Tennessee, had been advised and

DISTRIBUTION

3 to Commanding General, Third Army
 1 to OSI, Knoxville, Tennessee
 1 to FBI, Knoxville, Tennessee

WD-AGO FORM 568
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2

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SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

DATE
13 October 1950

PREPARING OFFICE

111th. CIC Detachment, FAO # 8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tennessee

SUBJECT

OBJECTS SIGHTED OVER OAK RIDGE, TENN.

CODE FOR USE IN INDIVIDUAL PARAGRAPH EVALUATION

OF SOURCE:

COMPLETELY RELIABLE A
 USUALLY RELIABLE B
 FAIRLY RELIABLE C
 NOT USUALLY RELIABLE D
 UNRELIABLE E
 RELIABILITY UNKNOWN F

OF INFORMATION:

CONFIRMED BY OTHER SOURCES . . . 1
 PROBABLY TRUE 2
 POSSIBLY TRUE 3
 DOUBTFULLY TRUE 4
 IMPROBABLE 5
 TRUTH CANNOT BE JUDGED 6

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

were on the alert for any unusual occurrences. Atomic Energy Commission officials advise that the Security Patrol heard only the one aircraft identified as the Air Force fighter. Further, the idea of ballons, flocks of birds, flying objects from AEC, and light aircraft from Sulphur Springs Airport, were rejected with good reason.

An officer at the Knoxville radar site and an officer from the Eastern Air Defense Command stated that they have seen such a pattern on radar scopes in the past for which there was never an adequate explanation. They hazarded the opinion that this pattern could have been caused by atmospheric or technical interferences, however, the exact cause has not been determined.

SOURCE: Major R. C. Care, Capt. W. Akin, Lt. Clevenger, (Knoxville Radar Site), Lt. Wolf (Pilot of fighter aircraft), Eastern Air Defense Command Representatives, Special Agent CSI, and an official of the Security Division, Atomic Energy Commission, Oak Ridge, Tennessee.

DISTRIBUTION: 3 to Commanding General, Third Army
 1 to OSI, Knoxville, Tennessee
 1 to FBI, Knoxville, Tennessee

DISTRIBUTION

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

DATE 17 October 1950

PREPARING OFFICE
CIC, FAO # 8, P.O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tennessee

SUBJECT	CODE FOR USE IN INDIVIDUAL PARAGRAPH EVALUATION	
	OF SOURCE:	OF INFORMATION:
OBJECTS SIGHTED OVER OAK RIDGE	COMPLETELY RELIABLE A	CONFIRMED BY OTHER SOURCES . . . 1
	USUALLY RELIABLE B	PROBABLY TRUE 2
	FAIRLY RELIABLE C	POSSIBLY TRUE 3
	NOT USUALLY RELIABLE D	DOUBTFULLY TRUE 4
	UNRELIABLE E	IMPROBABLE 5
	RELIABILITY UNKNOWN F	TRUTH CANNOT BE JUDGED 6

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION (Refer: Summary of Information, Subject: 'as above, dated 15 Oct 1950.)

On 13 October 1950 Atomic Energy Security Patrol Trooper, Edward D. Rymer, and a caretaker, John Moneymaker, from the University of Tennessee Research Farm, at Oak Ridge, saw an object at about 12,000 to 15,000 feet above Soloway Gate of the "Control Zone." This object appeared to be an aircraft which was starting to make an outside loop, trailing smoke behind. Soon these two men realized that the formerly described smoke behind the aircraft was a tail. This object continued to descend in a controlled dive, much slower than an aircraft would dive, and when it approached the ground it levelled off and flew slowly, parallel to the ground. This object came within two hundred and ten (210) feet of the two observers and was paralleling the ground at approximately the speed that a man could walk, at a height of approximately six (6) feet. Trooper Rymer attempted to approach the object but as he approached the object became smaller and started moving in a southeasterly direction. This object is said to have approached a nine (9) foot cyclone chain link fence and made a controlled movement to clear the fence, then a Willow tree, then a telephone post and wire, after which the object gained momentum and altitude and cleared a hill at approximately one (1) mile away. The object appeared to be pear shaped. When this object was over the hill it was still visible as the same sized object that was observed when only fifty (50) feet away. (The explanation given was that this object grew larger as it gained altitude and speed.)

Approximately five minutes later the object appeared again having reappeared from approximately the same location from which it had disappeared. The object was seen again five minutes later for approximately ten seconds.

During the above happenings, Mr. John Moneymaker had visual reference of this object during its first sight for approximately seven minutes. Trooper Rymer was interrupted twice during which times he called his headquarters in an attempt to get other observers. Also, during the fantastic flight of this object, Trooper Rymer stopped Mr. E. W. Hightower, who was on the highway in his vehicle, to verify what was being seen. Mr. Hightower's statement substantiates the description as before.

By the time the object appeared the second time, Joe Zarzecki, Capt. of the Atomic Energy Commission Security Patrol, was present and also witnessed this phenomenon.

Each of the observers described the object substantially as follows:

- a. When the object was first sighted it appeared to be an aircraft, trailing smoke, or better described as "smoke writing."

DISTRIBUTION 3 cc Headquarters, Third Army 1 cc to Security Division, AEC, Oak Ridge
1 cc OSI, Knoxville, Tennessee 1 cc File
1 cc FBI, Knoxville, Tennessee

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~~~SECRET~~

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

DATE
17 October 1950

PREPARING OFFICE

CIC, FAO # 8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tennessee

SUBJECT

OBJECTS SIGHTED OVER OAK RIDGE

CODE FOR USE IN INDIVIDUAL PARAGRAPH EVALUATION

OF SOURCE:

COMPLETELY RELIABLE	 A
USUALLY RELIABLE	 B
FAIRLY RELIABLE	 C
NOT USUALLY RELIABLE	 D
UNRELIABLE	 E
RELIABILITY UNKNOWN	 F

OF INFORMATION:

CONFIRMED BY OTHER SOURCES	 1
PROBABLY TRUE	 2
POSSIBLY TRUE	 3
DOUBTFULLY TRUE	 4
IMPROBABLE	 5
TRUTH CANNOT BE JUDGED	 6

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

- 7
it was
for yrs?
- b. When the object was approaching the ground in its descent, it took on the shape of a bullet with a large tail.
- c. When the object was sighted on the ground (from approximately two hundred and ten (210) feet) it appeared to be approximately the size of a 2x5 card, with a twenty (20) foot ribbon tail. The object and the tail was alternately moving up and down, and the ribbon appeared to be waving in the breeze. The color was a metallic grey.
- d. When Trooper Rymer came within fifty (50) feet of the object he described it similar to the above except that the first two and one-half feet of the tail appeared more solid, but the last seventeen and one-half (17½) feet of the tail appeared almost transparent and was glowing, intermittently, in sections. The tail appeared to have four or five sections which would glow intermittently.

Trooper Rymer's record is among the best of the troopers at the Atomic Energy Commission Security Patrol. Mr. John Moneymaker holds badge No. UT-1817, and is employed by the University of Tennessee Agricultural Research Farm as a caretaker for small animals. Mr. E. W. Hightower holds badge No. 6633 and is an employee of the Maxon Construction Company.

The Controller, Capt. W. Akin, of Detachment No. 2, 662 AC and W Sqd., McGee-Tyson Airport, P. O. Box 202, Maryville, Tennessee, at the Knoxville Airport Radar Site, made a report that he had seen peculiar readings on the radar scopes at approximately 1520 hours. Apparently the radar picture was indefinite, intermittent, and inaccurate, because the objects sighted by radar would only make a short "painting" on the scope and would then disappear only to reappear at another location.

On 16 October 1950, at approximately 1520 hours, five persons (as yet unknown) sighted objects hovering over the K-25 plant at Oak Ridge, Tennessee. Further information and description is expected from these sources. However, the radar scopes at Knoxville Airport were giving an unintelligible reading. Apparently the Commanding Officer was reluctant to make any statement concerning these readings due to higher Headquarters doubting the event of the past few days.

Nevertheless, a fighter aircraft from the 5th Fighter Sqd. was sent to identify an object which was reported to be hovering over K-25. Upon approaching the area the radar equipment aboard the aircraft got an image on its scope and the pilot pursued this image and identified it as a light type aircraft. Ground

2

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5

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SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

DATE 17 October 1950

PREPARING OFFICE

CIC, FAO # 8, P.O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tennessee

SUBJECT

OBJECTS SIGHTED OVER OAK RIDGE

CODE FOR USE IN INDIVIDUAL PARAGRAPH EVALUATION

OF SOURCE:	OF INFORMATION:
COMPLETELY RELIABLE A	CONFIRMED BY OTHER SOURCES . . . 1
USUALLY RELIABLE B	PROBABLY TRUE 2
FAIRLY RELIABLE C	POSSIBLY TRUE 3
NOT USUALLY RELIABLE D	DOUBTFULLY TRUE 4
UNRELIABLE E	IMPROBABLE 5
RELIABILITY UNKNOWN F	TRUTH CANNOT BE JUDGED 6

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

observers state that the fighter plane passed beneath the object which they were observing. The Security Division, Atomic Energy Commission, will attempt to have the observers, or some of the observers, make these same statements while undergoing a polygraph test.

- polygraph -

Further information will be submitted as soon as possible as soon as an adequate verification has been obtained.

SOURCE: Atomic Energy Security Patrol Trooper, Edward D. Rymer; John Moneymaker; Joe Zarzecki, Capt. of the Atomic Energy Security Patrol; E. W. Hightower; Officials of the Atomic Energy Commission, Security Division; Major Care, Capt. W. Akin, McGee-Pyson Radar Site;

3

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B

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SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

DATE
21 October 1950

PREPARING OFFICE

FAO #8, P.O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tennessee

SUBJECT

OBJECTS SIGHTED OVER OAK RIDGE,
TENNESSEE

CODE FOR USE IN INDIVIDUAL PARAGRAPH EVALUATION

OF SOURCE:

COMPLETELY RELIABLE A
USUALLY RELIABLE B
FAIRLY RELIABLE C
NOT USUALLY RELIABLE D
UNRELIABLE E
RELIABILITY UNKNOWN F

OF INFORMATION:

CONFIRMED BY OTHER SOURCES . . . 1
PROBABLY TRUE 2
POSSIBLY TRUE 3
DOUBTFULLY TRUE 4
IMPROBABLE 5
TRUTH CANNOT BE JUDGED 6

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION (refer: summaries of information, Subject; as above, dated 13 and 17 October 1950)

Attached to this Summary is eleven (11) inclosures which tend to clarify information contained in the former two (2) Summaries of Information on SUBJECT. These inclosures are composed of witness statements; background information concerning previous sightings of peculiar objects over Oak Ridge; and radar reports. The most reliable sources available were utilized in the compilation of this report. The employment records and the Federal Bureau of Investigation reports concerning the witnesses were inspected to ascertain their reliability, integrity, and loyalty to the United States Government.

The opinions of the officials of the Security Division, AEC, Oak Ridge; Security Branch, NEPA Division, Oak Ridge; AEC Security Patrol, Oak Ridge; FBI, Knoxville; Air Force Radar and Fighter Squadrons, Knoxville; and the OSI, Knoxville, Tennessee, fail to evolve an adequate explanation for SUBJECT, however the possibilities of practical jokers, mass hysteria, balloons of any description, flights of birds (with or without cobwebs or other objects attached), falling leaves, insect swarms, peculiar weather conditions, reflections, flying kites, objects thrown from the ground, windblown objects, insanity, and many other natural happenings have been rejected because of the simultaneous witnessing of the objects with the reported radar sightings; because of the reliability of the witnesses; because of the detailed, similar description of the objects seen by different persons; and because of impossibility.

The trend of opinions seem to follow three patterns of thought. The first is that the objects are a physical phenomenon which have a scientific explanation; the second is that the objects are experimental objects (from an undetermined source) guided by electronics; and the third is similar to the second except that an intended demoralization or harrassment is involved. The fantastic is generally rejected.

These objects have apparently followed only two patterns. The first is that they were sighted at the same hour on two consecutive days and the second is that the line of flight is either to or from the Northeast and Southwest, which directions parallel the terrain ridges in this locality.

Attention is invited to the 1947 photograph of a flying object (inclosure # 8). Atomic Energy Commission officials advise that the Air Force Laboratory at Wright Field, Ohio, indicate that the object is a water spot on the photograph. Because this object does not resemble other water spots of the photograph, and because the object in the second photograph is following the dim trail left by the first object, some officials at Atomic Energy Commission question the veracity of

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SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

DATE
21 October 1950

PREPARING OFFICE

FAO # 8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tennessee

SUBJECT

OBJECTS SIGHTED OVER OAK RIDGE,
TENNESSEE

CODE FOR USE IN INDIVIDUAL PARAGRAPH EVALUATION

OF SOURCE:

COMPLETELY RELIABLE A
USUALLY RELIABLE B
FAIRLY RELIABLE C
NOT USUALLY RELIABLE D
UNRELIABLE E
RELIABILITY UNKNOWN F

OF INFORMATION:

CONFIRMED BY OTHER SOURCES . . . 1
PROBABLY TRUE 2
POSSIBLY TRUE 3
DOUBTFULLY TRUE 4
IMPROBABLE 5
TRUTH CANNOT BE JUDGED 6

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

this statement. They also believe it significant that the Air Force did not return the negative of this print.

Following is a chronological summary of the reported events which have occurred at Oak Ridge, Tennessee.

June 1947 - Mr. [redacted] photographed a flying object at Oak Ridge, Tenn. The street in the foreground has been identified as Illinois Avenue, Oak Ridge, Tennessee. (Inclosure # 8)

20 June 1949 - At 1900 hours Mr. [redacted] and Mrs. [redacted] and Mrs. [redacted] sighted three objects at Oak Ridge, Tennessee, similar to SUBJECT. (Inclosure # 9)

1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, March 1950 - Mr. [redacted] reported peculiar readings on his "Ham" Radar Scope. These objects reappeared at approximately the same time of day which is similar to SUBJECT. (Refer: Summary of Information, Subject; Unidentified Objects Over Oak Ridge Vicinity, dated 6 March 1950.)

12 October 1950 - 2325 hours - Knoxville Airport Radar Unit indicated a series of unidentified targets over the "Restricted Zone" at Oak Ridge. (Incl. #1)

12 October 1950 - 2342 Fighter aircraft was at the position of the radar target and made three perfect interceptions but could see nothing. (Incl. #1)

13 October 1950 - 0000 to 0100 hours. Additional Radar plots as before. (Incl. #1)

13 October 1950 hours. Major L. E. Renniger, accompanied by his daughter, heard intermittent noises. (Inclosure # 7)

15 October 1950 - 1512 hours. Fighter plane made unsuccessful passes at a good radar target four (4) miles from the East Boundary (Kerr Hollow Gate). (Inclosure # 4)

15 October 1950 - 1520 hours. SUBJECT seen at Kerr Hollow Gate by Troopers Ryner and Zarzecki, Mr. Hightower, and Mr. Moneymaker. (Inclosures #3, 10, 11)

15 October 1950 - 1520 hours. Radar scopes at McGhee-Tyson Airport indicate unidentified targets. (Inclosure # 4)

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SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

DATE 21 October 1950

PREPARING OFFICE

FAO # 8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tennessee

SUBJECT

OBJECTS SIGHTED OVER OAK RIDGE,
TENNESSEE

CODE FOR USE IN INDIVIDUAL PARAGRAPH EVALUATION

OF SOURCE:

COMPLETELY RELIABLE A
USUALLY RELIABLE B
FAIRLY RELIABLE C
NOT USUALLY RELIABLE D
UNRELIABLE E
RELIABILITY UNKNOWN F

OF INFORMATION:

CONFIRMED BY OTHER SOURCES . . . 1
PROBABLY TRUE 2
POSSIBLY TRUE 3
DOUBTFULLY TRUE 4
IMPROBABLE 5
TRUTH CANNOT BE JUDGED 6

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

16 October 1950-1455 to 1530 hours. Objects seen by Troopers Isabell, Briggs and Clark. (Inclosures #5 and #6)

16 October 1950-1520 hours. Radar scopes at McGhee-Tyson Airport giving unintelligible readings. (Inclosure # 4)

16 October 1950-1956 to 2004 hours. NEPA Guards, Brown, Herron, and Davis report peculiar sounds. (Inclosure # 7)

Attached to the original only are two Knoxville OSI reports concerning SUBJECT.

CORRECTION on second page of the S/I, Subject as above, dated 13 October 1950, replace the word Oliver Springs for "Sulphur Springs".

SOURCE: Major R. C. Care, Capt. W. Akin, Lt. Clevenger, (Knoxville Radar Site); Lt. Wolf (Pilot of fighter aircraft); Eastern Air Defense Command Representatives; Special Agent OSI; Officials of Security Division, Atomic Energy Commission, Oak Ridge, Tennessee; Atomic Energy Commission Security Patrol; Security Troopers Rymer, Zarzecki, Briggs, Clark, and Isabell; John Moneymaker; E. W. Hightower; Federal Bureau of Investigation; Officials of Security Branch, NEPA, Oak Ridge, Tennessee.

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FIELD AREA GROUP #1

P. O. Box 379
Knoxville, Tenn

19 October 1950

The following accounts of activity at the Radar Operations Section, of Detachment # 2, 662nd AC & W Squadron, McGhee-Tyson Airport, Knoxville, Tennessee, is extracted from their official report dated 13 October 1950. Other pertinent information was submitted in a previous Summary of Information, Subject; Objects Sighted Over Oak Ridge, Tennessee, dated 13 October 1950.

"The first target, H-47 at 2325 E.S.T., 12 October 1950, appeared as per diagram (Inclosure #2). Then in rapid succession, we had H-48, H-49, and H-51 appear.

"Called AEC; they had no report of an aircraft at this time --2325.

"Called Atlanta; they had no flight plans on anything coming from the North.

"Arrow (Fighter aircraft) airborne at 2339 E.S.T. and vectored on 290 degrees, Angels (altitude) 2500. There were three perfect intercepts on the scope on H-48, but no joy (Fighter aircraft made no contact). Height Finder gave approximate angels of target at 3000. These angels varied from 1500 to 5000 feet on various targets throughout the evening. One intercept of H-48 was 14 miles at 270 degrees and from a stern approach; no joy.

"Pulled fighter off this target and sent him back into area at angels 5000. He made complete sweep of area and saw nothing

"Notified Radar Maintenance, who checked the operation of the Radar and switched channels.

"By this time all targets had faded and area was clear. We steered Arrow back to base and he pancaked (landed) at 0014, E.S.T., 13 October 1950.

"Very shortly after pancake, various targets again appeared through the area. They gave good paints (images) on the Radar Scope) but faded completely at times and then would reappear.

"AEC still had no report for us, but had alerted all guards and were beginning to get searchlights out in case they were needed.

"We did not report these additional plots to Nobody (Call sign for Air Defense Command Control Center, Selfridge Field, Ala.) until 0100. Called Captain Summers at this time and explained that the same Rat Race (activity on the radar scope) had started again. He knew of no practice mission by higher headquarters but said he would call EADF (Eastern Air Defense

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19 October 1950

Command, Stewart Air Field, Newburgh, New York). He called back and said their only instructions was to keep fighters on Alert Status. Told him we could have both off the ground in 4 (four) minutes.

"Targets were appearing with some regularity and proceeding South.

"They all traveled at a speed of between 100 and 125 miles per hour. Fading and reappearing at various intervals. All but one originated in the area. One did appear at 10 miles North of Clinton and faded right at the area line. Reappearance of this target or at least one on the same course 180 degrees was 8 (eight) miles inside area. This target faded after three sweeps (Revolutions of the indicator on the Radar Scope which makes four revolutions per minute).

"The tracks varied at time from one applicable to very light A/C (aircraft) up to A/C of the C-47 variety (Meaning the reflected intensity of Radar waves made the target appear at first like a small aircraft and then like a large one).

"We operated both on High and Low Beam and picked up the same tracks.

"All traveled at the same approximate speed and general course. During the night this course spread from 170 degrees to 230 degrees (magnetic compass heading).

"At 0210 E.S.T., called Captain Summers at Nobody; he called EADF, Captain Hutchinson, and received permission to release fighters to normal status."

AGENTS NOTES: This document was signed by Captain William Alkin, the Radar Controller on duty at the time of these occurrences.

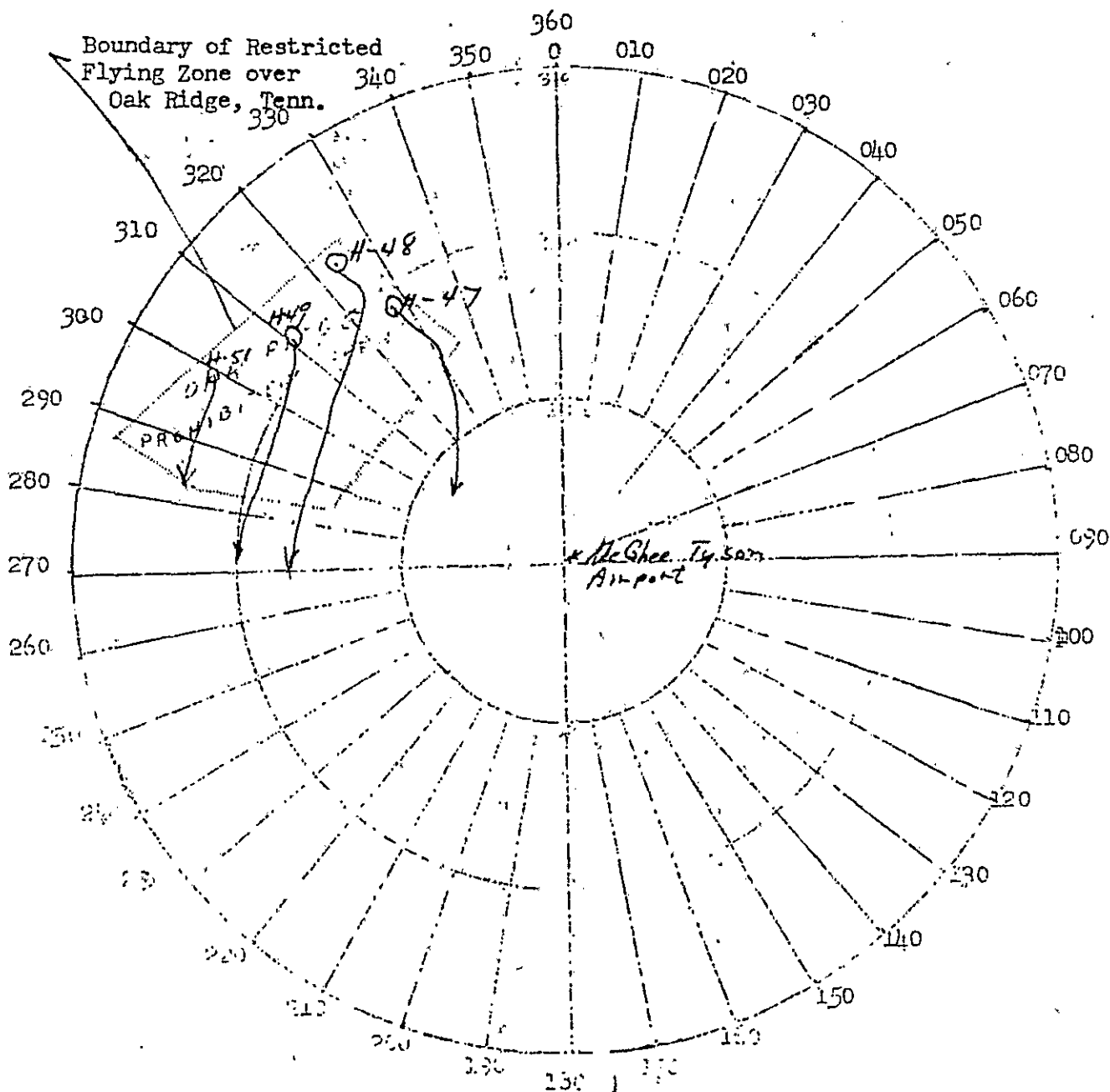
THIS IS A CERTIFIED TRUE EXTRACT COPY:

BY:

William B. Gray
SAC, Knoxville, Tenn.

~~SECRET~~

These objects appeared to be A/C small, traveling between 100 - 125 mph. AEC was notified but their guards didn't see a thing. 2339 E.S.T. our fighter was airborne to interrupt H-48. Pass directly over one target. Pilot couldn't spot a thing. These targets appearing along the N.W. corner. One at a time. Some were very strong echoes. Tracked from 15 to 20 miles.



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FIELD AREA OFFICE #8
P. O. Box 379
Knoxville, Tenn

16 October 1950

Description of object seen by Atomic Energy Commission Security Patrol Trooper Edward D. Rymer; who approached the object as close as Fifty (50) feet, at about 1520 hours on 15 October 1950, is substantially as follows: When first seen at an estimated altitude of twelve (12) to fifteen (15) thousand feet, the object appeared to be an aircraft starting to "skywrite". The "streamer" left behind is estimated to be approximately one-fourth ($\frac{1}{4}$) of a mile long. The object then started a controlled descent, almost vertical, at a slower speed than an aircraft would dive, and the "tail" followed the object. "It" then appeared to take the shape of a large bullet with a streamer, or ribbon, as thick as the bullet, trailing in the path of the object but connected to it. The object then levelled off parallel to the horizon, decreased its speed, and passed within seventy (70) yards of Rymer and another observer whom Rymer had stopped (John Moneymaker). Rymer had reported via telephone that this object was a "falling object". As the object decreased its speed to less than a man's normal walk, Rymer attempted to approach the object, but when he got within fifty (50) feet of it, the object moved toward the Southeast at about six feet altitude above the terrain; made almost a mechanical maneuver to go over a nine (9) foot cyclone chain link fence; then another similar maneuver to pass over a willow tree and a telephone line; and finally gained altitude and speed and went over a hill about one mile distance.

When Rymer was within fifty (50) feet of the object it appeared to be a two (2) by five (5) card (similar to the ones issued to vehicles entering the "Control Zone" at Oak Ridge) with a twenty (20) foot ribbon tail, the first two feet of which were easily visible and the last eighteen (18) feet of which was almost transparent and divided into several sections. The sections of the tail would pulsate a dim "glow" alternately. Through the entire length of the tail, was a black line which might be described as a "wire". The entire color was bluish-gray similar to the color of the top of a "wood cooking range". The "body" of the object was gently moving up and down, and the tail waved in the breeze like a ribbon or a worm and followed the path of the "body" of the object. There was no breeze at the time! (Knoxville Airport reports a high breeze of eight (8) miles per hour). Further, from fifty (50) feet away, the object looked no bigger than it did from two hundred and ten (210) feet away, and when it disappeared over the hill, one (1) mile away, it still looked the same size that it had appeared at only fifty (50) feet, but the "body" was then "bladder" or "pear-shaped".

When questioned further, Rymer stated that the object had to change size from the time they first observed it until it came near the ground; and it had to get larger as it went over the hill or they would not have been able to see it at such distances.

The object appeared two more times within the next ten (10) minutes and Rymer was able to get two other observers to verify that they could see the same "thing".

The three observers, other than Rymer, were E. W. Hightower, Maxon Construction Corporation, Badge No. 6633; John Moneymaker, caretaker of small animals at the University of Tennessee Agricultural Research Farm, Oak Ridge;

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FIELD AREA OFFICE #8
P. O. Box 379
Knoxville, Tenn

18 October 1950

and Joe Zarzecki, Captain of the AEC Security Patrol, Oak Ridge, Tennessee. At no time were any noises from this object heard.

AGENTS NOTES: Mr. George Rathman, AEC Security Division, stated that all these persons' description of the object was substantially the same when questioned separately, except that Rymer had been the closest and was the only person to report the transparent portion of the "tail". Moneymaker stated substantially the same except that he did not see the transparent portion of the "tail".

Moneymaker was wearing his glasses at the time and his vision, with glasses, is 20/20 in the right eye, and 20/30 in the left eye. Rymer's vision is 20/20 in both eyes without glasses.

Rymer's record indicates that he is one of the "better" and most respected troopers on the AEC Security Patrol. Nothing in his record indicates any weaknesses or peculiar inclinations.

Rymer stated that he would not have reported this incident if there had not been a witness. Moneymaker was reluctant to give information because of the fantastic nature of the incident.

Captain Zarzecki saw the object for only a moment on its third appearance and stated that the object appeared to be round as it crossed the sky at a high rate of speed.

NOTES: The above information was obtained on 16 October 1950 from interviews with Trooper Edward D. Rymer; John Moneymaker, Agriculture Section, University of Tennessee; George Rathman, Security Division, Atomic Energy Commission; John S. Davis, Chief of Atomic Energy Commission Security Patrol; and Captain Joe Zarzecki.

In addition, the Atomic Energy Commission Security Division took Geiger counters to the scene of the incident but could get no reading.

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FIELD AREA OFFICE #8
P. O. Box 379
Knoxville, Tenn

18 October 1950

The following accounts of activity at the Radar Operations Section of Detachment # 2, 662nd AC & W Squadron, McGhee-Tyson Airport, Maryville, Tennessee, is extracted from their official report, dated 15 October 1950. (Refer: Summary of Information, Subject; Objects Sighted Over Oak Ridge, Tennessee, dated 13 October 1950):

"Prior to this report, (report by AEC patrolman Edward Rymer) we had a recurrence of targets like Thursday night (Midnight 12 - 13 October 1950). We had sent one scramble (flight of aircraft) out and made several good passes at one target which painted (imaged on Radar Scope) very well. It was on a heading of 180 degrees (Magnetic compass heading) and approximately 4 (four) miles inside the Eastern boundary of the area (Restricted flying space where other aircraft are not supposed to fly). Our fighter worked from 2500 to 5000 feet but saw nothing. The speed of these targets varied from 40 to 100 miles per hour. Every characteristic was the same as before except that the speed was slower.

There was nothing on the scope (Radar Scope) at the location of this strange object (the location was called in by telephone from ground observers at Oak Ridge).

The strange visitor was reported to Captain Cole at Nobody (Call sign for Air Defense Command Control Center, Selfridge Field, Ala.) who carried through to EADF (Eastern Air Defense Command). Their orders were to put a patrol over the area, which was done.

Lt. Guthrie, operating under my control and later Captain Duffy's, saw nothing in the area except one large flock of birds, which were painting (giving images on the Radar Scope). He estimated their number between 200 and 300. This was at 7000 feet. His patrol up until 1730 E.S.T., when I left duty, ranged from a low level pass over the gates to 7000 feet.

He was vectored after several well painted targets, but saw nothing

EADF sent a list of questions to be answered by the observers. These answers were forwarded. They concerned speed, time, sky, and terrain conditions, altitude, when smoke disappeared, etc."

This report was signed by Captain William Akin, Controller at the Radar Site, at the time of these occurrences.

CERTIFIED TRUE EXTRACT:

William B. Gray
SAC, Knoxville, Tenn.

CAUTION

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This document contains information affecting the National Defense of the United States. Its transmission or the disclosure of its contents in any manner to an unauthorized person is prohibited and may result in severe criminal penalties under applicable Federal laws.

Incident Report

AEC PATROL

Closed _____
Date _____
By _____
W.R. _____
N.R. _____

Incident Report No. 1124-50

Date 10-16-50

Time 1:30 P. M.

CLASSIFICATION

Flying Object

TROOPER

John L. Isabell

LOCATION

Blair Gate

PERSON INVOLVED

Trooper Lendelle Clark
Trooper Hank N. Briggs

ADDRESS

BADGE NO.

212
156

COMPANY

PERSON INVOLVED

ADDRESS

BADGE NO.

COMPANY

REMARKS:

At approximately 1:30 P. M., October 16, 1950, while working at Blair Gate, I saw an object in the air over K-25 traveling in a northeast direction from the southwest. It was traveling in a straight line and going very fast. The object was white or silvery in color and round like a ball and was about the size of a baseball as seen at the distance it was from me. It seemed to be very high.

At exactly 2:55 P. M., October 16, 1950, this object reappeared from the northeast at a considerably low altitude and traveling a lot slower than before. I stopped a car that was coming in the gate in order to have witnesses to what I saw. The occupants of the car were Troopers Lendelle Clark and Hank N. Briggs going in to work. I pointed out the object to Troopers Clark and Briggs and we watched the object for several minutes. This object was slowly circling in a wide circle and spinning very fast, that is, the object itself was spinning around and around. The object drifted toward the southwest and in just a few minutes it reappeared at a very high altitude going back into the northeast and going very fast. We watched the object disappear into the northeast.

This information was phoned in to Headquarters immediately by the undersigned. About fifteen minutes after the object disappeared into the northeast, an F-82 Fighter plane showed up in the area where the object was last seen but appeared to be thousands of feet lower than the object which Troopers Clark, Briggs, and the undersigned saw and reported.

/s/ John L. Isabell, Trooper
Oak Ridge Patrol Force

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DATE

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Enclosure #5

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Incident Report
AEC PATROL

CAUTION
This document contains information affecting the National Defense of the United States within the meaning of the espionage laws, the transmission or the disclosure of its contents in any manner to an unauthorized person is prohibited and may result in severe criminal penalties under applicable Federal laws.

Supplement
Incident Report No. 1424-50

Date 10-16-50

Time 2:55 P. M.

Closed _____
Date _____
By _____
W.R. _____
N.R. _____

CLASSIFICATION	TROOPER	LOCATION	
Flying Object	John L. Isabell	Blair Gate	
PERSON INVOLVED	ADDRESS	BADGE NO.	COMPANY
Trooper Lendelle Clark		212	
PERSON INVOLVED	ADDRESS	BADGE NO.	COMPANY
Trooper Hank N. Briggs		156	

REMARKS:

On October 16, 1950, at approximately 2:55 P. M., Trooper Isabell stopped us at this Installation and showed us an object in the north that was traveling toward the northwest. It looked to be about 2,000 feet in the air and a white-silverish looking color, rotating in a counter clockwise manner. It was round in shape and going in a rather fast motion. This object was at a high altitude and seemed to come in sight and then disappear. It looked about the size of a ball and round at every angle we looked at it.

/s/ Lendelle Clark
/s/ Hank N. Briggs

Distribution:
1 - Callaghan
2 - Chief Davis' File
3 - Mail & Rec. File

OFFICE							
SURNAME							
DATE							

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Inclusive # 6

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FIELD AREA OFFICE #8
P. O. Box 379
Knoxville, Tenn

19 October 1950

The "Contract Guards" who guard the building at the NEPA project were warned by the NEPA Security Section to report any peculiarity, regardless of how silly or fantastic it might seem. These guards were unaware of the previous events concerning objects seen over Oak Ridge, but some of the guards had reported peculiar sounds during the evening of 16 October 1950.

Independent reports from different guards were received by the Security Section, NEPA, Oak Ridge. These reports were submitted by Guards S. R. Brown; H. C. Herron; and Geo. R. Davis. They all stated substantially the same and described hearing an intermittent noise resembling the blast of a Jet Fighter Aircraft. Each noise lasted for about three and one half (3½) seconds and would recur frequently between 1956 hours and 2004 hours on 16 October 1950. Each noise would sound like a jet plane which had increased its thrust tremendously. The sounds seemed to leave the vicinity making an ascent almost vertical. None of the guards could see an object in the sky.

On 17 October 1950, Major L. E. Ronniger, Sr. Instructor, ORC Group, Oak Ridge, Tennessee, returned from Nashville, Tennessee, and visited an official of the Security Division, Atomic Energy Commission, Oak Ridge, Tennessee. Major Ronniger was amused when informed of the fantastic sights that some of the persons at Oak Ridge had seen but then he recalled an incident which he thought was not connected to the "Objects Sighted over Oak Ridge." After having been away from Oak Ridge during Monday and Tuesday, the 15th and 17th of October 1950, and without knowledge of the occurrences which had taken place except for the item about which he was being told (which had to do with visual sightings of the object), Major Ronniger stated that he had heard a noise at about 1500 hours on 15 October 1950 which he described exactly as the guards who heard the noise on the night of 16 October 1950. Major Ronniger, accompanied by his daughter, attempted to locate a jet fighter in the sky but could see nothing whatever.

The Radar crew of Detachment #2, 662nd AC and W Squadron, McGhee-Tyson Airport, Knoxville, Tennessee, did not get an image on their scope during either of these occurrences, according to Major R. C. Care.

NOTES: The above information was obtained on 17 October 1950 from Major L. E. Ronniger; Mr. George Rathman, Security Division, Atomic Energy Commission, and Mr. Gene Gaedjion, NEPA, Oak Ridge, Tennessee, and John S. Davis, Atomic Energy Security Patrol.

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~
FIELD AREA OFFICE #8

P. O. Box 379
Knoxville, Tenn

20 October 1950

The attached photographs were taken in June 1947 by _____
218 Illinois Avenue, Oak Ridge, Tennessee, of what he thought was a
fantastic flying object. The first photograph, in which only the smoke
trail is visible, was taken a few minutes before the second photograph
where the flying object is in view.

On 19 October 1950, Mr. _____ stated that this object was
traveling in the same line of flight as the first object, and its distance
appeared to be approximately over the hills in the background.

NOTE: Only one set of photographs is available.

P. O. Box 575
Knoxville, Tenn

Incident Report

AEC PATROL

Incident report No. 142-50
Date: October 15, 1950
Time: 3:25 P. M.

Classification	Trooper	Location	
Unidentified Flying Object	E. D. Rymer	Kerr Hollow	
Person Involved	Address	Badge No.	Company
Trooper E. D. Rymer		206	"D" Troop.
Person Involved	Address	Badge No.	Company
Capt. J. J. Zarzecki		UT Farm 1817	
E. W. Hightower		Laxon 6633	

stopped at Kerr Hollow gate where I was on duty October 15, 1950, 3:20 P.M. He and I observed what appeared to be a skywriter in the air. He was one-quarter of the way through a letter "O". The object appeared to be 12,000 to 15,000 feet high and east by north of the gate, approximately one mile distance from the gate. At this time, the size appeared to be about the size of a four or five passenger plane. The object had a smoke trail the same crosssectional size of its body and about one-quarter of a mile long. The smoke was grayish in color. The color of the body of the object was silver metallic. The object gave off no reflection. It was dull in appearance. When first observed, it was describing an arc toward the ground. When the object failed to complete the outside-loop, I went into the gate house to report its appearance. Up till this time I thought it to be a plane doing some skywriting. While I was making the phone call, I watched the object continue downward to 1,500 feet. At that altitude, a second object was noticed alongside the smoke trail. The second object was the same size and shape and was about 50 feet behind the first object. The second object appeared to be attached to the first object's smoke trail with about an 80 degree forward thrust, yet the second object was moving in the same direction of the first object and not drawing away from the smoke trail of the first object the way it should have been doing according to its angle and direction. At this altitude, both objects changed from a bullet shape to a bladder shape. Also, at 1500 feet both objects began pulling out of the vertical dive. During the entire descent, both objects diminished in size. From 1,500 feet, the angle of descent was about 45 degrees. At about 500 feet, the second or trailing object disappeared. The object continued downward to a point north of the perimeter fence over the roadway about 60 yards from the gatehouse toward Solway bridge. This was where the object was when I came out of the gatehouse. At this time, the object had diminished to about 2x5 inches.

16 October 1950

The files

A. L. Rydzewski, Acting Assistant Chief, Security Division

REPORT OF MYSTERIOUS FLYING OBJECT

SYMBOL: S:ALP

Pursuant to receipt of a report from John S. Davis, Chief, Oak Ridge, Patrol, indicating that a mysterious flying object was observed in the vicinity of the Kerr Hollow Entrance, Ernest Willie Hightower, Maxon Badge No. 6633, was interviewed by F. P. Callaghan, Acting Chief, Security Division, AEC, ORO, in the presence of A. L. Rydzewski, Security Division, ORO, and Charles Jones, Security Agent, Maxon Construction Company, at approximately 10:15 p.m., October 15, 1950. Hightower is an electrician employed by the Edenfield Electric Company, which is under subcontract with the Maxon Construction Company, performing work at the K-29 Plant. He was born June 24, 1896, and at present resides at the Edgemore Grocery along the Edgemore Road. Hightower gave the following account of his observations. He was driving to work at approximately 3:15 p.m., October 15, 1950, and upon nearing the Kerr Hollow entrance to the Oak Ridge Controlled Area, he was requested by the guard on duty to stop and observe an object which the guard and another civilian were looking at. He got out of the car and noticed a white spot in the sky. He said it was "awful high" and moved from a position southeast of Kerr Hollow entrance in a westerly direction toward the Plant Areas. He noted that the sky was clear and the object was merely white, not shiny and emitted no trail of smoke and appeared to have no appendages. He observed the object for about 5 minutes and continued on his way to work before the white object disappeared from sight.

When asked what he thought of the object, Hightower related that his first impression was that it might be a toy balloon, because it looked quite similar to a toy balloon which one of the neighborhood girls had released in his presence several weeks ago. Hightower was not sure of the size or shape of the object, however he indicated by hand gesture that it might have been about 9 inches in diameter and probably was in the shape of a disc or ball.

Hightower said that the guard and civilian appeared to be excited and told him that when they first saw it, the object was "Quite big" and that it moved along the road at very low altitude and that it suddenly ascended at an angle to the point where they were observing it at the time. He stated that the guard originally asked him to look at the object, just to make sure that he wasn't merely imagining he was seeing things.

Incident Report No. 1423-50

The smoke trail had discontinued but there was a tail that had the appearance of a ribbon, about 5 or 6 feet long. At times the tail lengthened to almost 20 feet. While hovering, it had a burnt or dark brown appearance. The tail had an opalescent grayish appearance with a dark line running down through the center of it. The main object was still grayish metallic in color. The object was hovering about 5 or 6 feet above the road in a completely stationary position. I went toward the object and the object started moving southward as I moved toward it. When I got to within 50 feet of it, the main object was about 4 to 6 feet from the chain link fence on the south side of the road. It moved straight up to about 12 feet then described a horizontal movement southward across the fence, then it again moved straight up to about sixty feet where it again moved south over a light pole and a willow tree. After it passed over the willow tree, it changed its direction to the southeast. At this time, E. W. Hightower, Badge No. 6633, of Maxon Construction Company, came along and I stopped him and asked him to observe it. He was unable to see the object at first and I returned to the gatehouse to make another report. ~~He~~ continued his observation of the object and soon after I went into the gatehouse, Hightower sighted the object. The object was now ascending at an angle of about 45 degrees in a southeast direction. As it moved away, it got larger in size and again assumed a pear or bladder shape. The object continued in this manner until it had passed over the ridge south of Solway road and disappeared.

About five minutes later, Capt. Zarzecki drove up and as he came down the road I remarked that I wished it would show up again so he could see it. We looked toward the ridge and saw it again. The object was moving from west to east about 8 or 9 feet above the field south of the fence. Its speed was about 15 to 20 miles per hour. I motioned for Capt. Zarzecki to hurry out of his car. He came over to where we were standing on the first island from the gatehouse. Capt. Zarzecki looked to where I pointed and saw the object immediately. At this time, the object was about 200 feet high and ascending at about 45 degrees in a southeast direction. We saw it for about 60 seconds before it disappeared at about 1,500 to 2,000 feet. It had a bladder or pear shape at this time.

In about five more minutes, ~~William B. Gray~~ and I saw it again about 20 degrees above the center island house. It had pear shape again and appeared to be about the same size as a small pear. The object was moving west at about 20 miles per hour. It continued west about 50 feet above the road until we lost it in the glare of the sun. This was the last time it appeared. None of us noticed any odor at any time.

When I first saw the object diving, its speed was very slow. It was much slower than a plane could dive. On the 45 degree downward slant, it slowed even more. When it moved across the road, the speed was about 15 miles per hour. During the upward slant, the speed was much faster than the downward slant and it must have been increasing in size because as it drew away, we could see it just as plainly and about the same size as when observed up close.

The wind direction was north-northwest and 8 MPH, according to the Knoxville Weather Station.

REPRODUCED TRUE COPY:

William B. Gray
SAC, Knoxville, Tenn.

KNOWVILLE DETACHMENT
8th DISTRICT OSI (IG)
PO BOX 401
Knoxville, Tennessee

16 October 1950

SUBJECT: Visual Sightings of Unidentified Flying Objects
over Oak Ridge, Tennessee

TO : District Commander
8th District OSI (IG)
Maxwell AFB, Ala

1. At 0830 16 October 1950, Mr. George Rathman, Security Division, Atomic Energy Commission, Oak Ridge, Tennessee notified the undersigned that visual sightings of an unidentified flying object had been made by several persons at Oak Ridge. Accompanied by W. B. Gray, SAC Knoxville CIC, the undersigned proceeded to Oak Ridge.

2. At the AEC Security Division, Oak Ridge AEC Security Patrol Trooper Edward D. Rymer was interviewed by Mr. Rathman, Mr. Gray and the undersigned. In substance Trooper Rymer related the following: At about 1525 EST, 15 October 1950 Trooper Rymer was on duty at the Solway entrance to the Oak Ridge controlled area. He was conversing outside the guard house with Mr. [redacted] attendant at the University of Tennessee Research Farm Program, Oak Ridge. Mr. [redacted] happened to glance in the sky and called Rymer's attention to an object in the sky. The men observed that the object was starting to describe an arc in the sky. They estimated the object to be about twelve to fifteen thousand feet altitude. At this altitude the object resembled a sky-writing plane because smoke appeared to be trailing from the object. After the object described about a quarter of an arc it began to make a controlled descent at a speed estimated at about 100 miles per hour. Trooper Rymer then noticed that the object had no wings and that it appeared to be bullet shaped. By this time the men could observe that what appeared to be smoke coming from the object was an attached tail. At this time Trooper Rymer went in the guard house and called the Captain of the Guard to report a falling object. Mr. [redacted] continued to observe the object. When Trooper Rymer came out of the guard house the object had descended to a height of about six (6) feet and was about seventy (70) yards from the two (2) men. By this time the object had assumed the shape of a two (2) by five (5) inch grayish colored card and attached to the object was a ribbon like tail about twenty (20) feet long and an inch wide. The object had no thickness. The tail of the object, which was light gray in color, had a small black line running down through its center. The tail appeared to be waving or rippling and the latter fifteen (15) feet of the tail gave off a pulsating glow intermittently in different section of the fifteen (15) feet. The latter fifteen (15) feet of the tail appeared to be somewhat transparent.

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Trooper Rymer estimated that the object was traveling about three (3) miles per hour and that the main body of the object was rocking slightly showing the corners and the under and top side. Rymer advanced on the object to within fifty (50) feet but it did not appear to get any larger. At Rymer's approach the object picked up speed slightly, proceeded across the highway, came to a nine (9) foot chain link fence, rose vertically and parallel with the fence and proceeded over the fence. After clearing the fence it dipped toward the ground for a few feet and then rose sharply to clear a thirty (30) foot willow tree and proceeded in a southeasterly direction at an increased speed to a ridge about a mile away and disappeared over the top of the ridge. The object during the flight to the ridge, changed to a pear shape but the tail continued to be present. While the object was heading for the ridge a car driven by Mr. B.W. Hightower, employee of the Maxon Construction Company, Oak Ridge, approached the Solway gate. Trooper Rymer called Mr. Hightower's attention to the object and he also saw it disappear over the ridge. Shortly after the object disappeared Captain of the AEC Security Patrol Joe Zarzecki arrived at the scene. Shortly thereafter another similar object appeared in the sky within sight of the men at a height of about 300 feet, traveling in the same direction as the previous object and it disappeared over the same ridge. The object was visible to the men for about thirty (30) seconds. About five (5) minutes after the second appearance another similar object again was visible at an altitude of about 500 feet for about a ten (10) second interval.

3. After a discussion of the incident Mr. Rathman, Mr. Gray, Trooper Rymer and the undersigned proceeded to Solway Gate, scene of the observation. A check was made of Trooper Rymer's estimate of distances and they were found to be substantially accurate. The immediate area around the gate is fairly level with wooded hills and ridges rising around the area. There were no obstructions or hindrances to visibility noticeable. At the direction of Mr. Rathman Mr. [REDACTED] was brought to the scene. He gave substantially the same account as did Trooper Rymer except to add that while Rymer was phoning and the object had descended to about 1500 feet the object appeared to be pear shaped and another pear shaped object appeared on one side of the object. As it came lower the object assumed the 2" x 5" card shape.

4. Mr. Rathman related to Mr. Gray and the undersigned that he had checked the AEC file on Rymer and that he has an excellent record. He has never been cited for any infraction of the AEC rules, has a "Q" clearance, 20/20 vision and is well liked and respected by his co-workers. Captain Zarzecki also has an excellent record. Very little is known of [REDACTED] and Hightower at the present.

5. At 1400, 16 October Mr. Gray and the undersigned proceeded to the Air Force Radar Station at McGhee-Tyson Airport, Knoxville, Tennessee. Major R. C. Care, Defense Area Commander stated that the radar screen had picked up indistinct, unidentified objects during the afternoon of 15 Oct. Major Care produced the incident report of Captain W. J. Akin, controller. Excerpts from his report are as follows:

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"Prior to this report (Ryder's), we had a reoccurrence of targets like Thursday night. We had sent one scramble out and made several good passes at one target which painted very well. It was on a heading of 180 degrees and approximately 4 miles inside the eastern boundary of the area. Our fighter worked from 2500 to 5000 feet, but saw nothing. The speed of these targets varied from 40 to 100 miles per hour. Every characteristic was the same as before except that the speed was slower.

There was nothing on the scope at the location of this strange object.

The strange visitor was reported to Captain Cole at Nobody, who carried through to EADS. Their orders were to put a patrol over the area, which was done.

It Gutherie operating under my control and later Captain Duffy's saw nothing in the area except one large flock of birds, which we were painting. He estimated their number between 200 and 300. This was at 7000 feet. His patrol up until 1730 EST when I left duty, ranged from a low level pass over the gates to 7000 feet.

He was vectored after several well painted targets, but saw nothing."

6. At about 1520 EST 16 October, while the undersigned was present, a report came from the AEC Patrol to the radar station relating that a Trooper Isbell and four civilian employees at Oak Ridge had observed a "silver disk" hovering over the K-25 plant in the controlled area. The radar screen was able to pick up an indistinct target about every three (3) or four (4) sweeps of the indicator. An F-82 fighter plane was sent to attempt an intercept of the object. The airborne radar of the fighter picked up a target which later proved to be a light aircraft. The ground observers reported that the F-82 passed under the "silver disk", while it was in pursuit of the light plane. The crew of the fighter observed nothing unusual. Nothing further was learned of the sightings.

7. Investigation will continue 17 October at which time Trooper Isbell and other witnesses will be interviewed.

WILLIAM N. PRICE
S/A OSI
Detachment Commander

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KNOXVILLE DETACHMENT
8th DISTRICT OSI (IG)
PO Box 401
Knoxville, Tennessee

14 October 1950

SUBJECT: Unidentified Flying Objects over Oak Ridge, Tennessee

TO : District Commander
8th District OSI (IG)
Maxwell AFB, Ala

This letter is to confirm spot report given your headquarters on 13 October 1950.

Beginning at 2325, EST 12 October 1950 a total of eleven (11) objects and possibly more appeared on the radar screen of the CFC-1 Air Force Radar Station at McGhee-Tyson Airport, Knoxville, Tennessee. The objects began appearing on the north edge of the Oak Ridge controlled area and proceeded south for about twenty (20) to thirty five (35) miles at the rate of 100 to 125 mile per hour, at an altitude of 1000 to 5000 feet, on a course of 170 to 230 degrees and with densities varying from that of light liaison aircraft up to that of a C-47 type aircraft. Captain W. J. Akin, controller at the radar station "scrambled" an F-82 fighter at 2330 and the fighter was airborne at 2339. Captain vectored the plane on two (2) specific targets on stern approaches at distances of one (1) and eight (8) miles respectively. On each occasion the fighter appeared to intercept the target on the ground radar screen; however, on each occasion the crew of the fighter observed no target either visually or on their airborne radar screen. The aircraft returned to the airport at 0014.

After the sighting of the unidentified targets the Oak Ridge Security Patrol was alerted and attempts at ground observations were made; however, nothing could be seen or heard from the ground. At 0100 more objects, having the same reading as previously, appeared on the screen. On this occasion no attempt at fighter interception was made. Ground observation results in the Oak Ridge area were negative.

During the above sightings Eastern Air Defense Force Headquarters was notified and checked for possible flights in the area. Checks were also made with flight service at Atlanta and Maxwell AFB. All checks proved negative.

On the afternoon of 13 October 1950 the undersigned accompanied officials of the Security Division Atomic Energy Division and the Knoxville CIC office to the radar station where a conference was held with officers of the radar station and a team of radar experts from Eastern Air Defense Headquarters. Numerous explanation such as flocks of migratory birds, clouds, a flight of light planes from the nearby Oliver Springs Airport, etc. were ruled out. One explanation advanced that it might have been due to atmo-

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Ltr, Knoxville OSI Detachment, Subj: Unidentified Flying Objects over Oak Ridge, dtd 14 Oct 50, cont'd

spheric conditions. Further attempts to explain the sightings were postponed until a complete report was prepared by the radar station and until the RADF team had checked the various Air Force Commands and the other services.

In an evaluation of the above sightings the following conditions should be considered:

- a. Captain Ahin, the controller, is considered to be a competent and well qualified radar officer.
- b. The CPS-1 radar set undergoes daily maintenance. Such maintenance was performed on 12 October at 1600. Checks were made on the equipment during and after the sightings and found to be in good operating condition.
- c. The crew of the fighter plane is considered to be one of the four (4) best in the 52nd Fighter Group.
- d. Weather conditions during the incident were excellent. The sky was cloudless, the air was practically calm and visibility was excellent. Lt Wolfe, pilot of the F-82, reported that he had made visual sightings earlier in the same evening at a distance of ten (10) to fifteen (15) miles.

A more complete report will be rendered as soon as the findings of the RADF are learned and when the radar station report is completed.

WILLIAM K. PRICE
E/S
OSI
Detachment Commander

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SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

DATE

25 October 1950

PREPARING OFFICE

111th CIC Detachment, FAO # 8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tennessee

SUBJECT

OBJECTS SIGHTED OVER OAK RIDGE,
TENNESSEE

CODE FOR USE IN INDIVIDUAL PARAGRAPH EVALUATION

OF SOURCE:

COMPLETELY RELIABLE A

USUALLY RELIABLE B

FAIRLY RELIABLE C

NOT-USUALLY RELIABLE D

UNRELIABLE E

RELIABILITY UNKNOWN F

OF INFORMATION:

CONFIRMED BY OTHER SOURCES . . . 1

PROBABLY TRUE 2

POSSIBLY TRUE 3

DOUBTFULLY TRUE 4

IMPROBABLE 5

TRUTH CANNOT BE JUDGED 6

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

at 1655 hours, on 20 October 1950, Mr. Larry P. Riordan, AEC Badge No. 522, Superintendent of Security at X-10 in the "Control Zone" at Oak Ridge, Tennessee, while enroute from X-10 to the Oak Ridge residential area, on Benton Valley Road, saw an object in the sky which appeared to be directly over the University of Tennessee Agricultural Research Farm. This object gave the general appearance of an aerial balloon which had lost its "basket." In other words, the object was generally round; appeared to come together at the bottom in wrinkles (rather indistinct), and something was hanging below. The balloon was described as being from eight to ten feet long; of a lead pipe or gunmetal color; and seemed to be approximately one-fourth (1/4) mile from the observer, at a thirty (30) degree elevation above the horizon. The object was apparently stationary but since the observer was in a moving vehicle, he did not verify that it was stationary. As the vehicle in which he was travelling changed position, and went around a curve, Mr. Riordan noticed that this object appeared to be thinner. He concludes that by reason of his changing position, or the object changing its altitude, he observed another angle of the object which appeared to be thinner than upon his first sighting.

at the time of the observation there was adequate light and the object was plainly visible. Mr. Riordan is a responsible person, as is indicated by his position, and he has been aware of the many instances of reported objects flying in the sky. He is also very familiar with the weather balloons which are sent up hourly each day over Oak Ridge between 6:00 a.m. of one day until 1:00 a.m. of the next day. The size of these balloons vary but, generally, they are similar to a circus balloon which is about twenty-four (24) inches in diameter. Mr. Riordan is certain the object seen was not a weather balloon but his first impression was that this object was an experimental "bag" being utilized by the University of Tennessee Agricultural Research Farm.

Mr. Riordan has been the Security Chief of X-10 since 14 July 1943. His vision is normal except that he has negligible impairment of the right eye. Like many of the Atomic Energy Commission officials, Mr. Riordan has hoped for the opportunity to see one of these objects, and under the circumstances, he visualized it as accurately as possible.

at 1845 hours, on 24 October 1950, Mr. William E. Fry, Assistant Chief of Security, NEPA Division, Oak Ridge, Tennessee, while attending a Drive-in theater with his wife and child, at Oak Ridge, noticed an object in the sky North-Northwest of his position, at a thirty (30) to forty (40) degree

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SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

DATE
25 October 1950

PREPARING OFFICE

111th CIC Detachment, FAO # 8, P. O. Box 379, Knoxville, Tennessee

SUBJECT

OBJECTS SIGHTED OVER OAK RIDGE,
TENNESSEE

CODE FOR USE IN INDIVIDUAL PARAGRAPH EVALUATION

OF SOURCE:

COMPLETELY RELIABLE A
USUALLY RELIABLE B
FAIRLY RELIABLE C
NOT USUALLY RELIABLE D
UNRELIABLE E
RELIABILITY UNKNOWN F

OF INFORMATION:

CONFIRMED BY OTHER SOURCES . . . 1
PROBABLY TRUE 2
POSSIBLY TRUE 3
DOUBTFULLY TRUE 4
IMPROBABLE 5
TRUTH CANNOT BE JUDGED 6

SUMMARY OF INFORMATION

elevation. This object was moving gently in a horizontal plane, back and forth, within thirty (30) degrees of his line of sight. This object emitted a glow, varying in color from red to green, to blue-green, to blue, and to orange. The variations were checked on the vertical window post of Mr. Fry's vehicle and were witnessed by Mr. Fry's wife. The attention of another observer, the Projectionist at the Drive-in theater, was also called to the object and verification of this sighting was made. The object disappeared from his sight at 1920 hours.

At 1855 hours, on 24 October 1950, an Air Force Major, Lawrence Ballweg, NEPA Division, Oak Ridge, Tennessee, also saw from his residence an object which he described similarly. The object disappeared from the sight of Mr. Ballweg at 1920 hours, which coincides with the time of disappearance of the object from Mr. Fry's sight.

On 20 October 1950, at 1527 hours, aircraft No. AF-409, Pilot Wolf, 5th AF-Fighter Sqd., took off from the Knoxville Airport for a "local patrol". The Radar Unit at Knoxville Airport received readings on their Radar scope and sent the aircraft after these targets. The aircraft Pilot was unable to identify any flying object in the vicinity of the said targets. All targets were between eighteen (18) and twenty-five (25) miles from the Airport at 320 degrees. The aircraft was landed at 1713 hours. (Attention is invited to the fact that these targets were sighted at approximately the same time, and locality, that was reported by Mr. Larry Riordan.)

On 24 October 1950, at 1823 hours, several small, slow targets were seen on the Radar screen at the Knoxville Airport Radar Site. These targets appeared in the Southeast sector of the "Restricted Flying Zone" and over the city of Oak Ridge. These targets moved from the city area to and along the East boundary of the area. At 1826 hours, the fighter aircraft was "scrambled" and proceeded to the area where it was vectored among the targets but the pilot reported no visual contact with said targets. At 1920 hours the targets disappeared from the Radar Screen and the fighter was vectored toward another target believed to be one of three (3) aircraft enroute from Andrews Field to Stewart Field. (Note: 1920 hours is also the time that the object sighted by Mr. Fry and Major Ballweg disappeared from their view).

(Overall evaluation: C-3)

SOURCE: Mr. Larry P. Riordan, Security Superintendent, X-10; William M Price, OSI, Knoxville, Tennessee; Mr. George Rathman, Security Division, AEC, Oak Ridge, Tennessee; and Major Raymond C. Care, USAF Area Defense Commander, Knoxville Airport, Knoxville, Tennessee.

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By *[Signature]* *DATE* *24 Oct 50*

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FILE NO.

AJACI-4

SUBJECT

Investigation of reports from Oak Ridge regarding unidentified objects over the AEC

TO Col Meade

FROM Maj Martin

DATE 24 Oct 50

COMMENT NO. 1

Maj Martin/7142/dw

1. Investigation of reports from Oak Ridge regarding unidentified objects over the AEC installation was initiated 19 October 1950.

2. a. Interview with Mr. A. L. Rydzewski, Acting Assistant Chief of Security Division AEC, Mr. G. J. Rathman, Chief of Investigations Branch AEC and Mr. Robert Tharpe, Chief of Analysis Section, Security Division AEC, indicated that they did not question the reliability of the guard force personnel who sighted the objects. They expressed no opinion as to the source or composition of the objects but were unanimous in expressing a desire to reach a solution of the problem. There was no doubt of the fact that something has been flying about the area. (Above are former CIC personnel).

b. Mr. John S. Davis, Chief of AEC Patrol Force, does not question the reports of the troopers concerning the objects. It is his opinion that none of his force would jeopardize their jobs by making fictitious reports. Mr. Price formerly was with CID and bears an excellent reputation for maintaining the guard force of 313 troopers at a high standard.

c. Troopers Rhymers and Isabelle were interviewed at the scenes of the two incidents of 15 and 16 October. Trooper Captain Zarzecki verified Rhymers story and his own version at Kerr Hollow Gate, near the south east corner of the installation. Troopers Briggs and Clark verified Isabelle's story and their versions at Blair Gate near the north west corner of the installation. There is no question as to the sincerity of the reporting personnel.

d. Mr. James Robey, FBI Agent in Charge at Knoxville was interviewed regarding knowledge and activity of his organization concerning this subject. Mr. Robey stated that he has received reports of the incidents but no investigation is underway. He had no opinion as to the cause or composition of the objects. He was entirely cordial and cooperative.

e. Mr. William M. Price, Detachment Commander, OSI Knoxville. He and CIC Agent Gray have been working along parallel lines and he had no additional information. He did not express an opinion regarding source or composition of objects.

f. Captains Christopher and Rockwell were interviewed at the Radar Station base, but expressed no opinion as to source or composition of objects. They do not attribute the radar readings to mal adjustment or imagination. The only area from which they get unaccounted for readings are the AEC installation. Some of their sightings have been explainable. In a recent instance fighter planes made intersections with radar images but nothing in the air was seen by the pilots. A metal topped bus on the ground was determined to be causing reflective readings. Also they have picked up flocks of birds. The smallest

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24 OCT 50

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